

the computer, graphics have to be processed. If it falters, you face unresponsive screens and an overall bad experience.

Some processors do come with built-in graphics processing units on the same chip as the CPU. If you're planning to use the system for graphics-intensive jobs often, the on-chip GPU may not suffice. However for most other cases, they're sufficient. GPUs built into processor chips are decent enough for a good Windows Aero performance and other tasks. When possible, look for a processor with a higher graphics frequency. There are some features built into the on-chip graphics processors which help you stream videos wirelessly, support better HD playback and faster media conversions and so on. However, while they may appear alluring, fact is, you probably don't require all the features. For example, if you don't intend on watching 3D content on your laptop, looking for InTru 3D in the specifications sheet is baseless. However if you're a developer or a designer, then you could use the extra displays, in which case an on-chip GPU supporting three displays would be better than a GPU supporting only two.

It's noteworthy that most of the power consumption depends on CPU and GPU. The more CPU/GPU intensive the task, the lesser will be the battery back-up for your system. When the computer boots, the operating system loads consuming the most power required for spinning the hard disk. The same thing happens when you load any new program. Once the program is loaded, the power consumption comes down to a minimum level and thereafter it fluctuates depending on the load produced by the program on the processor. More the processing required by the program, more the power consumption. The same applies to the GPU. If you're performing multimedia work on the machine, it calls out to the graphics unit for more leverage. Combined, the GPU and CPU provide most of the power requirements of the machine.

There are a few other features which are shown on Intel's website (AMD comparatively shows only a handful). Let's go through some features whose availability should be considered as well:

1. **Hyper-Threading:** This technology provides the user with two threads per processor core, thus elevating the performance. Most processors are already bundled with this tech.
2. **Virtualization Technology:** AMD and Intel call it AMD-V and Intel VT-x, respectively. It comes into the picture when you're trying to run virtual machines using VMWare Workstation or VirtualBox. For some virtualization software such as KVM/QEMU or XEN, the presence of virtualization technology is mandatory.